CITIZEN JOURNALISM

Tunisia v. Myriam Bribri

9 October 2026

CASE FOLLOW-UP REPORT

Procedural developments and verified outcomes

Independent research based on user-supplied TrialWatch materials

ABOUT THIS UPDATE

This independent research update follows the user-supplied TrialWatch material. It is not issued by the Clooney Foundation for Justice, TrialWatch, or the original authors. The earlier report supplies the historical baseline; later developments are supported by the sources cited here.

Jurisdiction	Tunisia
Original report	June 2021
Dated update covered	9 October 2022
Research cutoff	9 October 2026
Historical assessment	No letter grade assigned in the original

SCOPE AND METHOD

Research considered public court records, enacted legislation, lawyers and subjects, press-freedom organizations, United Nations materials and attributable reporting available through 9 October 2026. Publication dates and event dates are distinguished. Where judgments or current custody records could not be obtained, the conclusion is expressly qualified. No direct interviews or new trial monitoring were conducted for this update.

An acquittal, quashing order, pardon, sentence completion, bail decision and custody transfer have different legal effects. A reported intention to litigate is separated from an actual filing. Unresolved questions are listed below. Historical TrialWatch grades retain their original attribution; this update does not assign a new grade.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

LATEST VERIFIED POSITION

December 2021 conviction appealed; appellate result unverified

Latest dated follow-up is an NGO statement announcing an expected 12 October 2022 ruling, not verification that the ruling occurred. Sources disagree on the December conviction and appeal dates. Amnesty describes a suspended custodial sentence; earlier sources describe provisional liberty. No current custody status is established.

Unlike the June 2021 pre-disposition report, later sources establish a December 2021 conviction under Article 86 of the Telecommunications Code, a four-month custodial sentence and a TND 500 fine, followed by an appeal. Amnesty described the prison term as suspended and reported a prosecution appeal as well. The latest dated follow-up located, published on 9 October 2022, announced an expected ruling on 12 October; the ruling itself was not verified. [3] [5] [6]

The proper conclusion is not acquittal, imprisonment served, or a final conviction. The subsequent appellate result and enforcement position remain unresolved in the researched record through 9 October 2026. The supplied report assigned no letter grade. [1]

1. User-supplied original report, June 2021.
3. United Nations special rapporte..., 14 February 2022. AL TUN 2/2022: Communication concerning Merie...
5. Amnesty International, 28 September 2022. Tunisie. Les accusations sans fondement pesan...
6. Women Journalists Without Chains, 9 October 2022. WJWC call for dropping false charges against...

BACKGROUND AND PROCEDURAL HISTORY

Bribri, a blogger and activist documenting police abuses, faced proceedings over a Facebook video and accompanying criticism of police violence in October 2020. The original traced the complaint, questioning and successive hearing adjournments, with another hearing scheduled for 28 June 2021. At publication, it did not record a conviction. [1]

The report examined Article 86's prohibition of knowingly harming others or disturbing their peace through public telecommunications networks. Its concerns included the criminalization of political criticism, the breadth of the offense and effective preparation of the defense. These historical observations should not be silently converted into a judgment about the later appellate proceedings, whose records have not been obtained. [1]

KEY PROCEDURAL DATES

October 2020	Video and commentary on police violence led to the Article 86 prosecution. [1]
December 2021	Convicted and sentenced; HRW, the UN communication and Front Line Defenders give 21 December, while Amnesty gives 20 December. [2] [3] [4] [5]
December 2021	Defense appeal filed; UN account gives 22 December and Amnesty 23 December. Amnesty also reports a prosecution appeal. [3] [5]
25 January 2022	HRW reports provisional liberty pending appeal; historical custody observation only. [2]
14 February 2022	UN special rapporteurs send communication AL TUN 2/2022 concerning prosecution and defense safeguards. [3]
27 September 2022	Front Line Defenders announces an appeal session scheduled for 28 September in Sfax. [4]
9 October 2022	WJWC statement announces an expected 12 October ruling; no result established by this statement. [6]

1. User-supplied original report, June 2021.
2. Human Rights Watch, 25 January 2022. Une activiste tunisienne condamnee a une pein...
3. United Nations special rapporte..., 14 February 2022. AL TUN 2/2022: Communication concerning Merie...
4. Front Line Defenders, 27 September 2022. Woman human rights defender Meriem Bribri app...
5. Amnesty International, 28 September 2022. Tunisie. Les accusations sans fondement pesan...
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SUBSEQUENT DEVELOPMENTS

HRW's January 2022 account, based in part on contact with Bribri, documented a conviction and provisional liberty pending appeal. The February UN communication likewise recorded an appeal and raised alleged restrictions on access to prosecution evidence. This was an actual communication by special rapporteurs to Tunisia, not merely a proposed submission, but it was not a judicial finding that Tunisia had violated a treaty. [2] [3]

Front Line Defenders' September notice confirms an announced appeal session. Amnesty's contemporaneous statement adds two legally important qualifications: it describes the sentence as suspended and says both defense and prosecution appealed. A suspended prison term is not imprisonment already served, and a prosecution appeal makes it unsafe to presume that only a reduction or acquittal was in issue. The exact procedural scope requires the appeal records. [4] [5]

The October WJWC statement supplies a later scheduled decision date, not the decision's contents. Searches under Myriam, Meriem, Breibri and Arabic spellings did not establish a certified or reliably reported appellate outcome. The absence of a located result is a research limitation, not evidence that the case had no later developments. [6]

LEGAL AND PROCEDURAL ASSESSMENT

The following assessment draws inferences from the cited record. It does not represent a new court finding or TrialWatch grade.

the material change from the original is a movement from prosecution to conviction and appellate litigation. That materially changes the legal posture even though the outcome remains unverified. It is therefore inappropriate either to retain a simple 'awaiting trial' label or to infer finality from the passage of time. [1] [3]

the divergent dates and sentencing descriptions warrant preserving attribution rather than selecting one account without explanation. A registry extract or signed judgment could determine whether the apparent discrepancy concerns pronouncement, recording or reporting; none of those explanations is established here. [2] [5]

1. User-supplied original report, June 2021.
2. Human Rights Watch, 25 January 2022. Une activiste tunisienne condamnee a une pein...
3. United Nations special rapporte..., 14 February 2022. AL TUN 2/2022: Communication concerning Merie...
4. Front Line Defenders, 27 September 2022. Woman human rights defender Meriem Bribri app...
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6. Women Journalists Without Chains, 9 October 2022. WJWC call for dropping false charges against...

CONCLUSION AND OUTSTANDING RECORDS

A conviction and appeals are documented, but neither the scheduled appellate ruling nor subsequent enforcement has been verified. The follow-up should present that substantive development alongside an explicit unresolved-outcome qualification. [3] [5] [6]

RECORDS NOT VERIFIED

1. Signed first-instance judgment confirming date, suspension terms and fine.

2. Defense and prosecution appeal notices, their grounds and filing dates.

3. Whether a decision was delivered on 12 October 2022 or another date, and its operative terms.

4. Any later review, enforcement, payment or custody record, and Tunisia's response to AL TUN 2/2022.

Failure to locate an update leaves a gap in the available evidence; it does not establish that no later proceeding or change occurred. Any present-status claim should be read with the dated scope stated in the executive summary.

3. United Nations special rapporte..., 14 February 2022. AL TUN 2/2022: Communication concerning Merie...

5. Amnesty International, 28 September 2022. Tunisie. Les accusations sans fondement pesan...

6. Women Journalists Without Chains, 9 October 2022. WJWC call for dropping false charges against...

SOURCES AND REFERENCES

Numbered references correspond to superscript citations and page notes. Web sources were consulted for this research through 9 October 2026. Original reports are local user-supplied files. Each link opens the cited source.

1. **Original user-supplied report on Tunisia v. Myriam Bribri**
TrialWatch / original report authors. June 2021.
Local PDF: Myriam-Bribri_June-2021_Fairness-Report (2).pdf
Coverage: Historical case baseline and original assessment

2. **Une activiste tunisienne condamnee a une peine de prison pour avoir critique la police**
Human Rights Watch. 25 January 2022.
Read source at www.hrw.org
Coverage: 21 December conviction; provisional liberty awaiting appeal in January 2022.

3. **AL TUN 2/2022: Communication concerning Meriem Bribri**
United Nations special rapporteurs / OHCHR. 14 February 2022.
Read source at spcommreports.ohchr.org
Coverage: Reported conviction and 22 December appeal; fine; provisional liberty; concerns about disclosure of evidence.

4. **Woman human rights defender Meriem Bribri appeal session is scheduled for 28 September 2022**
Front Line Defenders. 27 September 2022.
Read source at www.frontlinedefenders.org
Coverage: Scheduled Sfax appeal session; 21 December conviction account.

5. **Tunisie. Les accusations sans fondement pesant sur Myriam Bribri doivent etre abandonnees**
Amnesty International. 28 September 2022.
Read source at www.amnesty.org
Coverage: 20 December date; suspended four-month sentence; TND 500 fine; defense and prosecution appeals.

6. **WJWC call for dropping false charges against a Tunisian activist**
Women Journalists Without Chains. 9 October 2022.
Read source at www.wjwc.org
Coverage: Expected ruling on 12 October 2022; does not establish its outcome.